



to score in this edition of the Copa America.

He found the net from the penalty spot in Ecuador's 3-1 win against Jamaica.

Currently playing for Independiente del Valle, it was announced on June 5, 2023, that Paez would join the Blues in the Premier League after his 18th birthday in the summer of 2025.

James on song for Colombia

James Rodriguez's career has been one of ebbs and flows. Once considered the next big thing in world football, the 32-year-old's journey hasn't always gone as planned.

However, Rodriguez has been a revelation in this Copa America, being a major cog in Colombia's excellent campaign so far, which saw it win its first two matches and secure a place in the quarterfinals.

Against Paraguay, Rodriguez assisted both of Colombia's goals in

A great start: Ecuador's young sensation, Kendry Paez (10), will join Chelsea in 2025. REUTERS

its 2-1 victory.

In the subsequent match, he provided another assist as his team secured a 3-0 against Costa Rica to book a ticket for the knockouts. If Colombia aims to go far in this campaign, Rodriguez will be pivotal.

Brazil catches momentum after a slow start

Despite being packed with talent and having a strong legacy, Brazil

faced criticism following a goalless draw against Costa Rica.

This led to speculation about whether it would be an uneventful tournament for Vinicius Junior and his teammates.

However, the 'Samba Boys' bounced back in their second game, decisively defeating Paraguay 4-1, with Vinicius scoring twice.

As of July 2, Brazil has not yet secured a place in the quarterfinals, something which Dorival Junior's team will aim to achieve with a win against Colombia in its final group match.

Aneesh Dey

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